



Obscurathon 1.0

(Handoff through the riddles, uncovering the unseen)

Rulebook

1. Event Overview

Obscurathon 1.0 is a unique relay-style hackathon where teams of three members develop Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) solutions for real-world problems. Unlike conventional hackathons, team members work sequentially, with no direct communication or prior hints about previous work.

This event tests participants' **problem-solving skills, adaptability, debugging abilities, and the ability to collaborate indirectly**. The key challenge is to ensure seamless **synchronization of thought**—how well each team member builds upon their predecessor's progress without prior knowledge.

2. Event Details

Organized By:

The Computer Science and Engineering Society, IIT (ISM) Dhanbad

Prizes: Total prize pool of Rs. 18K and goodies.

The team securing the first position gets a cash prize of Rs. 9K and certificates.

The team securing the second position gets a cash prize of Rs. 6K and certificates.

The team securing the third position gets a cash prize of Rs. 3K and certificates.

Venue:

Waiting Arena → Seminar Hall, Third Floor, Department of CSE

Competition Arena → Lab 04, Third Floor, Department of CSE

Monitoring Arena → Lab 03, Second Floor, Department of CSE

Date:

31st March 2025 (Monday, Public Holiday for Eid)

Event Schedule:

Activity	Time
Reporting Time	10:00 AM
Release of Themes	11:00 AM
Competition Begins	11:30 AM
Competition Ends	5:00 PM
Judging Round	5:00 PM – 6:30 PM
Results & Felicitation	7:00 PM onwards

3. Team Composition & Eligibility

Each team must consist of **THREE (3) members**.

All members must be **B.Tech, M.Tech, Dual Degree, Double Major, or Research Scholars** from the **Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IIT (ISM) Dhanbad**.

4. Format & Execution

4.1 Relay-Style Competition

- Team members work **one at a time** in a relay format with **no direct communication**.
- Each participant gets **90 minutes** for planning, development, and analysis of the partial solution(if any).
- Once a participant's session ends, the next participant enters **without prior knowledge** of what has been done.
- Strategic team order selection is crucial as it affects overall performance.

4.2 Areas of Competition & Movement Rules

Competition Flow:

1. Registration & Event Launch:

- All three team members must be present during the registration and initial briefing.

2. Waiting Arena:

- The first participant moves to the **waiting arena** 30 minutes before their turn.
- They must submit their **mobile, tablets, laptops, watches, and other devices** before entering.
- No digital devices are allowed in this area.

3. Competition Arena:

- Every next participant will arrive in the waiting arena at least 30 minutes before their turn. They move from the **waiting arena** to the **competition arena** at their designated time.
- They work for **90 minutes**, similar to the first participant.

4. Post-Session Rules:

- **Monitoring Room:** Participants who complete their coding session can watch their team's progress through a live camcorder feed but **cannot communicate** with their teammates.
- Once the first participant's session concludes, he/she will have to move to the **monitoring room** and fill a cryptic questionnaire which will be handed over to the third participant when he/she arrives at the waiting arena. Post this the first participant can choose to watch the team progress via live camcorder feed or leave the venue, collecting their mobile phones.

- When the second participant's session concludes, he/she can choose to watch the team progress via live camcorder feed in the **monitoring room** or leave the venue, collecting their mobile phones.
- No mobile phones/tablets/laptops are allowed in the **waiting arena**, **competition arena**, and the **monitoring room**.

4.3 Theme & Problem Statement Allotment

- Themes will be revealed at **11:00 AM**.
- The first participant will randomly pick a **chit** to determine the problem statement.
- The second and third participants will only learn about the problem when they enter the **competition arena**.

4.4 Submission Policy

- All teams must use **one GitHub repository** for submission.
 - A **git commit is mandatory** at the end of each participant's session.
 - **Only three commits** are allowed (one per participant).
 - Additional commits will lead to penalties unless approved due to emergencies.
 - Commit messages must clearly indicate the participant number (e.g., **"Commit by Participant 1"**).
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5. Laptop & Device Policies

- **Only one laptop per team** for the entire competition.
 - **No device replacements** are allowed.
 - **The Internet is permitted only for development** (e.g., API documentation, Stack Overflow, GitHub).
 - **AI-generated code (ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot) is allowed.** However the previous participant cannot drop hints in the chat history. Everything will be cleared by the volunteers before the handoff.
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6. Communication & Handoff Rules

- **Strict No-Communication Policy:**
 - No notes, comments, or messages in the codebase/files.
 - No verbal, written, or digital cues.
 - **Violation Penalty:** Immediate disqualification for any breach.
 - **Random laptop inspections** will be conducted to ensure compliance.
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7. Cheating & Disqualification Policy

- Unauthorized communication is prohibited.
 - Attempting to interact with teammates leads to disqualification.
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8. Judging Criteria (500 Points)

Criteria	Description	Weightage
Synchronization of Thought	How well participants build upon each other's work without prior communication.	150
Innovation & Uniqueness	Novelty and creativity in approach and solution design.	70
Code Quality & Maintainability	Code structure, readability, modularity, and best practices.	70
Scalability & Performance	Efficiency, optimization, and ability to scale.	70
User Experience & Design	UI/UX quality, usability, and accessibility.	50
Presentation & Justification	Ability to explain and justify implementation decisions.	50
Completion of Core Features	How much of the intended solution is functional.	40

- Teams will be evaluated as follows: If a team **fails to present a working prototype**, evaluation will be based on **code structure and approach**.
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9. Additional Rules & Notes

- **Pre-Event Preparation:**
 - No pre-written code is allowed.
 - Teams can set up their **development environment** but cannot code in advance.

- **Ethics & Fair Play:**

- Respect towards organizers, volunteers, and judges is mandatory.
- Misconduct will result in disqualification.

- **Technical Support:**

- No extra time for hardware issues (e.g., laptop crashes).
- In case of network failure, event organizers will determine a fair resolution.

10. Result Declaration & Felicitations

- Competition ends at **5:00 PM**, followed by judging rounds from **5:00 PM – 6:30 PM**.
- Winners will be announced at **7:00 PM**, followed by a felicitation ceremony.

Final Notes:

Obscurathon 1.0 is an extreme test of adaptability, debugging, and logical deduction. The event challenges participants to **synchronize their problem-solving mindsets** without direct communication, simulating real-world scenarios where developers must work on legacy or incomplete codebases.

Plan wisely, follow the rules, and embrace the ultimate challenge!